

Questions on the parish choir texts

ST. JOHN OF DAMASCUS ORTHODOX CHURCH, TYLER, TEXAS · 8 AUGUST 2026

We have been working through the fixed Divine Liturgy music you sent, and most of it is now in the system — the abridged antiphons and the Royster wording are already in place and rendering. A handful of points remain where we would rather ask than guess.

Each question has a little context first, then the question itself, with space beneath for your answer. Short replies are plenty; anything you skip we will simply leave as it stands.

1. The published edition of the antiphons

Your copy of the Krasnostovsky First and Second Antiphons is abridged: the First Antiphon jumps from measure 34 to measure 81, and page 2 of the Second Antiphon is a physical cut-and-paste joining measure 35 to measure 72. You have confirmed this is what the parish sings, so the copy is cut by intent rather than incomplete. We would like the complete published text on file so our version is whole, even though the parish sings the short form.

Which published edition are these Krasnostovsky antiphons from — publisher, booklet name, or where they were obtained?

ANSWER

2. “Glory to the Father” placement

Your book contains a separate short piece titled “Glory . . .” before Psalm 145 (Second Antiphon), with only the words “Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.” We see no corresponding “Glory... now and ever...” at the end of Psalm 102.

At the end of the First Antiphon (Psalm 102), do you sing “Glory... now and ever...”, or is the only Glory the one that comes before Psalm 145?

ANSWER

3. The end of Psalm 102

The last system of your First Antiphon reads “Bless the Lord, O my soul; Blessed art Thou, O Lord” — the same as the opening line. We have assumed this is the opening line sung again as a reprise, rather than a separate closing verse.

Is that right?

ANSWER

4. “NAP”

Every engraved page is signed “Translation: +Dmitri (Royster); NAP”. We have not expanded “NAP” anywhere in our text because we do not know what it stands for.

What does NAP stand for?

ANSWER

5. The Cherubic Hymn

The page is headed “Cherubim Hymn – 1”, which suggests your book holds further numbered settings. We currently use the Bortniansky setting from that page for every Sunday.

Is setting 1 the one normally sung, or does it rotate through others? If it rotates, could we get the other settings?

ANSWER

6. The Litya at Vespers

We currently render three Litya idiomela; the parish Vigil booklet prints two. This may be a deliberate parish practice.

How many are sung?

ANSWER

7. Communion hymn wording

We render “will” where the parish booklet appears to read “shall” — “we *shall* walk” and “*shall* exult” against our “will”.

Which is correct for your use?

ANSWER

8. Beatitudes troparia at the Liturgy

Your Beatitudes page annotates verse 5 with “(on 8)”, verse 7 with “(on 6)”, and verse 9 with “(on 4)” — the verse at which the troparia begin for an eight-, six-, or four-troparia count. We have recorded these but have not yet wired them, because we do not have the canon-ode troparia texts themselves.

Do you have a source for the Beatitude troparia (the canon odes), or do you use a particular book for these?

ANSWER

Settings referenced above: Krasnostovsky (antiphons), D. Soloviev (Only-Begotten Son), Zboinka (Beatitudes), Bortniansky (Cherubic Hymn), and the unattributed “Akathist melody” (Creed) — all from the fifteen-page “Fixed sections Liturgy” scan.